

Compression works

Revise 360 lesson plan — 60 minutes

Unit	OCR J277 1.2 Memory and storage — Paper 1, Computer systems
Lesson	Compression works (lesson 15 of the unit)
Lesson ID	ms-l15
Experience ID	ms-l15
Plan ID	PLAN-MS-L15
Content version	2f43789058d7
Website	https://revise360.co.uk/experience.html?id=ms-l15

Big question, outcomes and success criteria

Big question — What are the effects on a file for each type of compression?

Prerequisites

The lesson before this one is ms-l14. Pupils should already have finished it: the starter below retrieves from it.

Earlier in the unit: ms-l01, ms-l02, ms-l03, ms-l04, ms-l05, ms-l06, ms-l07, ms-l08, ms-l09-test, ms-l10, ms-l11, ms-l12, ms-l13.

Assessable outcomes

1. **ms-l15-o1** — know why data is compressed
2. **ms-l15-o2** — understand the difference between lossy and lossless compression
3. **ms-l15-o3** — know why some data can only be compressed losslessly

Vocabulary, resources and preparation

Key vocabulary — Lossy compression, Lossless compression

Resources

SLIDES	presentations/MS_L15_CompressionWorks_Lesson.pptx
WORKSHEET	worksheets/MS_L15_CompressionWorks_Worksheet.docx
ONLINE EXPERIENCE	experience.html?id=ms-l15

Before the lesson

1. Sign in on the **teacher dashboard** (teacher.html) and open **Class logins**. Enter the class or group and the usernames, one per line, then print the login cards. A pupil cannot sign in without one, so do this before the lesson rather than in it.
2. Print the worksheet, one per pupil.
3. Open the slides and the experience once yourself, on the machine you will be teaching from, so the 360 image is already cached.
4. Check headsets or devices are charged and on the school network.

How pupils get in

1. Go to `topics.html` on `revise360.co.uk`.

2. Sign in with the **username and PIN from the login card**. The class is already set against the card.
3. Choose the topic, then this lesson's card.

Worth knowing before you promise anything. In this build APP_CONFIG.backendUrl is empty, so logins, login cards and progress are stored on the device the pupil used. The teacher dashboard says so too. A pupil who moves to a different machine starts again, so keep a class on the same devices within a unit, and treat the paper worksheet as the record that travels.

Teaching sequence

Sixty minutes including transitions. The online block is the one to move if your lesson is shorter: see the adaptation at the end.

MIN	PHASE	TEACHER	PUPILS	EVIDENCE TO CHECK
0-5	Retrieve	Starter on the board or the worksheet, from the last lesson and this lesson's prerequisites.	Answer the starter on the worksheet.	The starter box on MS_L15_CompressionWorks_Worksheet.docx is filled in.
5-8	Review the starter	Take answers; correct the one most got wrong.	Correct their own starter.	A correction written, not just a tick.
8-18	Explain and model	The new idea in two or three steps, with the example worked in front of the class.	Listen and answer questions about the example.	They can say why, not only what.
18-21	Set up and settle	Sign-in, launch, and what to write before anyone taps an answer.	Sign in, open the lesson, find Why compress?.	Everyone is in and on station 1.
21-43	Online: work the stations in order	Pupils read each wall, write the key fact and the challenge, then answer at the badge.	Read each wall, write the key fact and the challenge, then answer at the badge.	The worksheet has writing on it for each of the 6 stations before the badge is tapped.
43-48	Check understanding	The hinge question, hands down.	Answer the hinge question, hands down.	The split across the options.
48-56	Apply	Exam practice on the worksheet, in silence.	Exam practice, in silence.	worksheet, Exam practice a) to c)
56-60	Exit and set up the next lesson	The exit question and the retrieval link to next lesson.	Write the exit answer.	One sentence that answers the big question.

The explanation and the worked example

This is what the walls of the experience say, station by station. Teach the first two or three from the front before anyone puts a headset on; the rest the pupils read for themselves.

1. Why compress?

- Smaller files use less storage space.
- They transfer faster and use less bandwidth, so streaming and downloads work better.
- More files fit on a device, and web pages load quicker.

Challenge on this wall: Give three reasons a website compresses its images.

2. Lossy compression

- Some data is permanently removed to make the file much smaller.

- The removed detail is chosen to be hard for people to notice, such as sounds outside normal hearing.
- The original file can never be recovered.

Challenge on this wall: Name two file types that use lossy compression.

3. Lossless compression

- No data is lost: the file is rewritten more efficiently, and can be restored exactly.
- Patterns and repeats are recorded once instead of many times.
- The saving is smaller than with lossy compression.

Challenge on this wall: Why must a program file be compressed losslessly?

4. Which one, when?

- Photos, music and video: lossy is fine, and the saving is big.
- Text, spreadsheets, program files and archives: lossless only.
- Sometimes both: a video may use lossy video with lossless subtitles.

Challenge on this wall: Choose lossy or lossless for five file types, and justify each.

5. Run-length encoding

- A lossless method: instead of storing every pixel, store the colour and how many times it repeats.
- 001 1011 means eleven pixels of colour 001.
- It works brilliantly on images with large blocks of one colour, and badly on noisy photos.

Challenge on this wall: Encode the first two lines of the image using run-length encoding.

6. Does it always help?

- RLE shrinks images with long runs of the same colour.
- On a detailed photo, where colours change every pixel, it can make the file bigger.
- Compare the raw size with the compressed size to decide.

Challenge on this wall: Compare the raw data size and the compressed size for your image.

Retrieval and the check for understanding

Starter — A three-minute song is about 30 MB uncompressed, but under 3 MB as an MP3. Suggest what could have been removed, and what could not.

Answer space: 3 lines on the worksheet.

The answer is in the teacher answers for this unit, not on this plan: a plan left on a desk should not give it away.

Hinge question

Use this one, hands down, before anyone moves on to independent work. It is a real activity from the experience (ms-115-s3-c2), so the wording a pupil sees matches the wording you say.

Why must text and program files use lossless compression?

Correct: Losing even one character or instruction would corrupt the file

What a pupil might choose instead

- They are too small to compress
- They contain no patterns
- Lossy compression is illegal for text

Count the hands on each. If more than a few of the class are on one wrong option, that option is the misconception to teach against before anyone goes on: go back to the station this question sits on and work through its example again, aloud, before the independent work.

The course's own response to a wrong answer here: A program with missing bits simply won't run.

One response, not four. one response covers every wrong option; it does not say what to revisit for each one, so decide your own reteach for each option before the lesson - the list above is the start of it.

Guided to independent practice

STAGE	ACTIVITIES	WHAT IT IS
Recognise	11	The answer is on the screen and the pupil picks it: multiple choice, choosing several, matching a pair.
Construct	3	Nothing is offered. The pupil classifies, orders, fills in a table or works a number out, and types or places the answer.

Scaffolds already in the product, and how they fade

- **Hint** is a ladder, not a door: the first rung names the idea, the next shows the shape of the code, the next how it starts, the last animates the technique on different data. A pupil asks for each rung. None of them is the answer.
- **Run** is free and unmarked; **Check my answer** marks. A pupil may run as often as they like, which is what makes trial and error safe.
- **I need help** says to ask you, and says plainly that the question still has to be completed. It does not notify anyone and it does not unlock anything.
- The worked example appears on every early activity and on none of the late ones. That fade is deliberate; it is not a missing example.

Accessibility

- **Read aloud** on every task window reads the task and its brief, with the prescribed values read as values rather than as punctuation.
- Text is 16px or larger throughout, and a question window scrolls rather than shrinking its type.
- Prescribed data is boxed and in a monospace face as well as coloured, so it still reads as code in black and white, in a high-contrast mode, and to a pupil who does not separate green from amber.
- **Lower literacy and EAL:** pre-teach the vocabulary above; let the pupil say the key fact before writing it; accept the key fact in two or three words.
- **SEND:** the sequence is compulsory but the pace is not. A pupil may finish a station next lesson; the progress saves after every answer and reopens at their earliest unfinished question.
- A headset is never required. Every experience works on a laptop or a tablet with a mouse or a finger.

Delivering the online experience

Before anyone enters

- Worksheet out, pen in hand. The rule is write first, then answer at the badge: the first answer is the one that counts.
- Say where the stations are. They are numbered around the room: 1 and 2 to the right, 3 and 4 behind, 5 and 6 to the left, and the final challenge on the floor.
- Say that a badge marked **Not yet** is not a fault. It opens when the station they are on is finished.

The stations, and what to record at each

#	STATION	ACTIVITIES	RECORD ON PAPER
1	Why compress?	2	Files are compressed because...
2	Lossy compression	2	Lossy compression...
3	Lossless compression	2	Lossless compression...
4	Which one, when?	1	Lossy is used for... Lossless is used for...
5	Run-length encoding	2	Run-length encoding works by...
6	Does it always help?	2	Run-length encoding works best when...
final	Final challenge: compress it	3	the answer to the station's challenge

Where to pause

Stop the class after station 2 and take answers to its challenge out loud. That is the point where a pupil who has misread the technique can still be put right cheaply.

Afterwards

Headsets off and down. Ask three pupils for the key fact from a station of your choosing, in their own words and not read off the sheet. Then the exit question.

Assessment, evidence and unfinished work

ID	QUESTION	MARKS	WHERE
ms-115-x1	Give two reasons why files are compressed before being sent over a network.	2	worksheet, Exam practice a); deck, Exam practice slide
ms-115-x2	Compare lossy and lossless compression, using an example of a file that suits each.	6	worksheet, Exam practice b); deck, Exam practice slide
ms-115-x3	Explain why run-length encoding shrinks a cartoon image more than a photograph.	3	worksheet, Exam practice c); deck, Exam practice slide

Expected answers

Model answers and marking guidance are teacher-only and are not printed on this plan. They are in the unit's teacher guide pack, and the per-activity marking for this lesson is in `answers/records/ms-115.json`, which is not published with the website.

Common errors

The wrong options the activities offer are the errors this lesson expects. The commonest to watch for:

- **Which is a benefit of compression for a video streaming service?** — Videos gain extra detail; It stops piracy
- **What happens to the data in lossy compression?** — It is rearranged but all kept; It is encrypted
- **Which file types typically use lossy compression?** — Word documents and spreadsheets; Program files
- **What is the key feature of lossless compression?** — It always gives the smallest file; It removes unimportant detail
- **Why must text and program files use lossless compression?** — They are too small to compress; They contain no patterns

Unfinished work

Record where each pupil stopped, not a tick. They resume at their earliest unfinished question, and a station left half-done is the thing to open next lesson. Do not mark the lesson complete for a pupil who did not finish it: the score screen already shows what was and was not done, and that is the honest record.

Exit, next lesson and homework

Exit check

One of these, written, not a show of hands:

- Why data is compressed
- Lossy and lossless
- Run-length encoding

The confidence columns on the worksheet are a supplement to this, not a substitute: a pupil who rates themselves confident and cannot answer the exit question has told you nothing.

Retrieval link to next lesson

Next is ms-116, Revision HQ 1.2 part 2. Use this lesson's big question as next lesson's starter, so the first thing they do is retrieve it.

Homework

Finish any station left open, on the website, from the question they stopped at. If the class has no devices at home, set the exam practice on the worksheet instead and mark it next lesson.

Shorter lessons, longer lessons and no internet

A 40 to 45 minute lesson

Keep the starter, the explanation and the model at full length: cutting those is what makes the online work fail. Take the time out of the online block and the apply phase. Pupils stop where they are; their progress saves after every answer and reopens at their earliest unfinished question, so the next lesson starts there.

If the internet or the devices are unavailable

Teach from the slides and the worksheet. The slides carry the same teaching as the station walls, and the worksheet carries the key facts, the challenges and the exam practice. Set the online stations when the devices are back.

There is no offline version of the experience, and this plan does not contain one. Do not hand out a printed walkthrough of the stations as a substitute: the experiences are used on the website.

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